E-5 PROMOTION BOARD · MASTER STUDY GUIDE

20 NOV 2026
Battalion Promotion Board

Steadfast & Ready.

What the board will ask, how to answer it, and what you still have to confirm, organized by topic.

UNIT	BRIGADE / DIVISION	INSTALLATION
C Co, 2-12 IN	**2SBCT, 4ID**	**Fort Carson, CO**

MUST KNOW Expect it. Memorize word for word.

KNOW Likely follow-up. Know it cold.

BONUS Shows depth if you have time.

NEW Added in the expanded edition.

VERIFY Standard doctrine. Confirm in the publication before you lock it in.

LOCAL Get it from your unit. Nothing in this guide replaces it.

FIXED Corrects something in your old notes.

0 Start Here

Board format, corrections to your old notes, and the order to study in.

The board

Battalion board, 20 Nov 2026.
Uniform: **AGSU**.
Sequence: **Creed first**, then questions.

The panel

President: Battalion CSM.
Members: 1SGs of A Co, B Co, C Co and HHC.
Every member gets a topic.

Still open

MOI not issued yet. Once it is, check the reporting procedure, the creed you'll be asked for, and the topics against Section 0 of this guide.

Corrections from your old notes

Old note says	Correct answer	Why it matters
FIXED 1-12 IN lineage (Co A, 1st Bn)	**2-12 IN**: constituted 3 May 1861 as **Company B**, 1st Bn, 12th Infantry	That was the wrong battalion. You're 2-12. See Section 22.
FIXED SALUTE: U = Uniform	U = **Unit**	ATP 3-21.8 para 1-25
FIXED OPORD para 5 = Command and Control	Para 5 = **Command and Signal**	ATP 3-21.8 para 2-113
FIXED TC 4-02.1 is first aid	**ATP 4-02.11** (23 Mar 2026) superseded it	Don't cite an obsolete TC
FIXED FM 3-25.26 land nav	**TC 3-25.26** (15 Nov 2013)	Current APD index
FIXED FM 27-2 physical fitness	**FM 7-22** and **ATP 7-22.02**	FM 27-2 is not the PT reference
FIXED 3rd TCCC phase: "combat casualty evac plan"	**Tactical Evacuation Care**	The three phases are CUF, TFC and TACEVAC
FIXED Recovery Drill items 6 and 7 swapped	6 = **Groin Stretch**, 7 = **Calf Stretch**	ATP 7-22.02 Ch 16
FIXED Shot process: "steady position, aiming, breathing, trigger squeeze"	**Stability, Aim, Control, Movement**	That's the old 4 fundamentals. TC 3-22.9 uses the new ones.
FIXED AR 600-20 is the SHARP reg	**AR 600-52** (11 Feb 2025)	AR 600-20 Ch 6 = EO
FIXED AR 600-63 is suicide prevention	**AR 600-92**. AR 600-63 is Army Health Promotion.	The dedicated regulation
FIXED DA Form 5501 for tape	**DA Form 5500** only. 5501 is no longer used.	Army Directive 2026-13
FIXED ADP 6-22 = "Army Talent Management"	ADP 6-22 = **Army Leadership and the Profession**	Wrong title

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RULE FOR EVERY ANSWER

Address the member who asked: "First Sergeant, ..." or "Sergeant Major, ...". Give the answer, then the reference if you know it. If you don't know, say **"First Sergeant, I do not know the answer, but I will find out."** Never guess a number or paragraph. A confident wrong answer hurts you more than an honest "I'll find out."

1 Creeds & Army Values

Your board opens with a creed. Get it perfect, because it sets the tone for everything after.

VERIFY WORD FOR WORD

The texts below are the standard published versions. Before you lock them in, compare every word against army.mil/values/nco.html and army.mil/values/soldiers.html. Most boards ask for the **NCO Creed**. The MOI will say which one.

MUST KNOW THE CREED OF THE NONCOMMISSIONED OFFICER

No one is more professional than I. I am a noncommissioned officer, a leader of Soldiers. As a noncommissioned officer, I realize that I am a member of a time honored corps, which is known as "The Backbone of the Army". I am proud of the Corps of noncommissioned officers and will at all times conduct myself so as to bring credit upon the Corps, the military service and my country regardless of the situation in which I find myself. I will not use my grade or position to attain pleasure, profit, or personal safety.

Competence is my watchword. My two basic responsibilities will always be uppermost in my mind—accomplishment of my mission and the welfare of my Soldiers. I will strive to remain technically and tactically proficient. I am aware of my role as a noncommissioned officer. I will fulfill my responsibilities inherent in that role. All Soldiers are entitled to outstanding leadership; I will provide that leadership. I know my Soldiers and I will always place their needs above my own. I will communicate consistently with my Soldiers and never leave them uninformed. I will be fair and impartial when recommending both rewards and punishment.

Officers of my unit will have maximum time to accomplish their duties; they will not have to accomplish mine. I will earn their respect and confidence as well as that of my Soldiers. I will be loyal to those with whom I serve; seniors, peers, and subordinates alike. I will exercise initiative by taking appropriate action in the absence of orders. I will not compromise my integrity, nor my moral courage. I will not forget, nor will I allow my comrades to forget that we are professionals, noncommissioned officers, leaders!

HOW TO LOCK IT IN

Each paragraph starts with its own anchor: **Professional** → **Competence** → **Officers**. Recite it out loud 3 times a day, standing at attention, ideally in front of someone who can follow along with the text. Speak at a steady pace. If you stumble, pause, then keep going. Don't start over.

MUST KNOW THE SOLDIER'S CREED

I am an American Soldier.

I am a warrior and a member of a team.

I serve the people of the United States, and live the Army Values.

I will always place the mission first.

I will never accept defeat.

I will never quit.

I will never leave a fallen comrade.

I am disciplined, physically and mentally tough, trained and proficient in my warrior tasks and drills.

MUST KNOW Army Values: LDRSHIP

- **L** Loyalty
- **D** Duty
- **R** Respect
- **S** Selfless Service
- **H** Honor
- **I** Integrity
- **P** Personal Courage

KNOW Warrior Ethos

The four highlighted lines in the Soldier's Creed: *mission first · never accept defeat · never quit · never leave a fallen comrade.*

I always maintain my arms, my equipment and myself.

I am an expert and I am a professional.

I stand ready to deploy, engage, and destroy, the enemies of the United States of America in close combat.

I am a guardian of freedom and the American way of life.

I am an American Soldier.

KNOW Army Profession: ADP 6-22

ADP 6-22, Army Leadership and the Profession (31 Jul 2019, incl. C2). Chapter 1 covers the Army Profession and its ethic.

VERIFY The five essential characteristics of the profession are **Trust, Honorable Service, Military Expertise, Stewardship, Esprit de Corps**.

BONUS Army facts

Army birthday: **14 June 1775**. The NCO Corps and the Infantry share it.
Motto: **"This We'll Defend."**
Song: **"The Army Goes Rolling Along."**

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **Name the Army Values.**	Loyalty, Duty, Respect, Selfless Service, Honor, Integrity, Personal Courage. **LDRSHIP.**
Q **What are the two basic responsibilities of an NCO?**	Accomplishment of the mission and the welfare of Soldiers. (NCO Creed, paragraph 2)
Q **What is the Warrior Ethos?**	I will always place the mission first. I will never accept defeat. I will never quit. I will never leave a fallen comrade.
Q **What publication covers Army leadership and the profession?**	ADP 6-22, Army Leadership and the Profession.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q **Which Army Value is the hardest for you to live, and why?**	Pick one honestly, such as selfless service when you're tired. Give an example and what you do about it.
Q **What does "time honored corps" mean to you?**	The NCO Corps dates to 1775. It's a tradition of leaders who carry out the mission and take care of Soldiers. Now you're joining it.
Q **Define integrity.**	Do what is right, legally and morally. Being honest in word and deed, even when no one is watching.
Q **Define selfless service.**	Put the welfare of the Nation, the Army and your subordinates before your own.
Q **Define personal courage.**	Face fear, danger or adversity, both physical and moral.

2 Board Procedure & AGSU

Your appearance and how you report in are graded before you answer a single question.

LOCAL CHECK: THE MOI DECIDES

Below is a common battalion-board sequence. Some details vary by unit: whether you salute an NCO board president, how many knocks, and the exact reporting phrase. Ask your 1SG or a recent board-goer, and follow the MOI once it comes out.

Typical reporting sequence

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[Knock once, firmly. Wait.]
CSM: "Enter."
[Enter. Close the door. March by the most direct route to about 2 paces in front of the president, centered. Halt.]
YOU: "Sergeant Major, Specialist ________ reports to the President of the Board." [Salute if the MOI says to. Hold it until it's returned or you're told to drop it.]
CSM: "Recite the NCO Creed." [Stand at attention. Speak up and keep your eyes forward.]
CSM: "Take your seat." [Sit straight, back off the chair back, feet flat, hands palms down on your thighs.]
CSM: "Tell the board about yourself." [See Section 4.]
[Each 1SG asks questions. Address each one as "First Sergeant."]
CSM: "Stand up. You are dismissed." [Stand at attention. Salute if required. Face about. Exit and close the door.]
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Bearing

- Eye contact with whoever asked the question.
- No fidgeting, "um," or "like." Pause instead.
- Speak a little louder and slower than feels natural.
- If you didn't hear the question: "First Sergeant, could you repeat the question?"
- If you make a mistake, correct it calmly: "Correction, First Sergeant..."

What graders usually score

- Military bearing and self-confidence
- Personal appearance and uniform
- Oral expression and conversational skill
- Knowledge of world affairs LOCAL
- Awareness of programs and leadership
- Basic Soldiering knowledge

Confirm the actual scoresheet in the MOI.

AGSU checklist

Item	Standard	Status
Ribbons (coat)	Male: centered 1/8 inch above the left breast pocket. Order of precedence from **wearer's right to left**. No more than 4 per row. **Ribbons are not authorized on the AGSU shirt.**	VERIFY DA Pam 670-1
Badges	When wearing two or more, place them in order of precedence from the wearer's right (highest) to left. Only **one badge per pocket**. **Miniature badges are not authorized on the AGSU.**	VERIFY army.mil FAQ
Nameplate, unit awards, DUI, combat patch, service stripes, rank	Measure every item against **DA Pam 670-1, AGSU chapter**. Sources online contradict each other on nameplate wear, so don't trust a vendor website.	LOCAL Have an NCO measure
ERB/ORB match	Everything on your chest must be on your record, and the other way around. Board members check.	MUST
Grooming	Haircut 1–2 days out. Clean-shaven unless you have an approved exception. See Section 9.	MUST

Fit and finish	Pressed, lint-rolled, no strings, shoes shined, belt or tab aligned. Bring a lint roller and a spare shirt.	MUST

DO THIS BY 16 NOV

Put the full uniform on and get a squad leader or PSG to inspect it with a ruler. That leaves time to buy or replace anything that's missing.

3 Chain of Command & NCO Support Channel

Usually the first questions after the creed. Know every name, rank, and spelling.

SENIOR LEADERSHIP CHANGED IN 2026

The names in the "last reported" column come from public sources as of Nov 2026. Some of these positions changed this year: the Chief of Staff was replaced in April 2026, and the Secretary of the Army may be serving in an acting capacity. **Confirm each name with your unit or on army.mil before the board**, and write the confirmed name in the last column.

Chain of command

Position	Last reported	Confirmed
Commander in Chief	President Donald J. Trump	
Secretary of Defense (Secretary of War)	Pete Hegseth	
Chairman, Joint Chiefs (sometimes asked)	Gen. Dan Caine, USAF VERIFY	
Secretary of the Army	Dan Driscoll; reportedly Adam Telle (acting) since Sep 2026 VERIFY	
Chief of Staff of the Army	GEN Christopher LaNeve (acting since Apr 2026) VERIFY	
Corps CG	LOCAL	
4ID & Fort Carson CG	MG Patrick J. Ellis	
2SBCT Commander	COL Hugh W.A. Jones VERIFY	
2-12 IN Commander	LTC Travis Stellfox VERIFY	
C Co Commander	LOCAL	
Platoon Leader	LOCAL	

NCO support channel

Position	Last reported	Confirmed
Sergeant Major of the Army	SMA Michael R. Weimer	
Corps CSM	LOCAL	
4ID CSM	CSM Waylon D. Petty VERIFY	
2SBCT CSM	LOCAL	
2-12 IN CSM (board president)	LOCAL	
C Co First Sergeant	LOCAL	
Platoon Sergeant	LOCAL	
Squad Leader	LOCAL	

Board members

Seat	Name
A Co 1SG	
B Co 1SG	
C Co 1SG	
HHC 1SG	

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What is the NCO support channel?	The channel from the SMA down to the first-line leader. It parallels and reinforces the chain of command. NCOs use it to pass information, standards, and individual training and welfare issues. VERIFY AR 600-20, Ch 2.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q Why is it important to know your chain of command?	So you know who gives orders and who is responsible, and so issues get routed to the right level.
Q What's the difference between the chain of command and the NCO support channel?	The chain of command issues orders and holds command authority. The NCO support channel backs up the chain, focusing on standards, training and Soldier care.
Q Who is the senior enlisted leader of 4ID?	The Division CSM. VERIFY name.

4 NCO History, Duties & Personal Questions

These are where the board decides whether you're ready to lead. Prepare your answers. Don't wing them.

"Tell the board about yourself" (60–90 seconds)

Structure

1. **Name, rank, MOS, unit, position.** "Specialist ____, 11B, Team Leader in 2nd Platoon, C Company, 2-12 Infantry."
2. **Hometown and time in service.**
3. **Your career so far:** M320 grenadier, Stryker driver, SAW gunner and rifleman, now team leader.
4. **One or two accomplishments:** schools, ranges, rotations (NTC, the border mission), awards.
5. **Goals:** BLC, civilian education, next position.
6. **Close:** "...and that is a little about me, Sergeant Major."

Leave out family drama, politics, and anything you can't defend.

Write your version here

Questions to prepare answers for

Question	What a strong answer includes
Why should you be promoted?	Evidence you already perform at the next level, such as leading your fire team or training Soldiers on the 320 and driving. Show you know the standard, plus one specific example.
What does it mean to be an NCO?	Connect it to the creed: the Backbone of the Army, the two basic responsibilities, leading by example, and enforcing standards.
What will you do in your first 30 days as a SGT?	Get to know your Soldiers (initial counseling, family, goals). Learn your equipment and task status. Set your standards. Meet your leadership's intent.
One of your Soldiers comes to you with a problem you can't fix. What do you do?	Listen. Make sure they're safe. Use the right resource (chaplain, MFLC, Behavioral Health, SHARP, AER). Inform your chain. Follow up.
A Soldier is late for formation for the second time.	Find out why. Do event counseling on DA Form 4856. Apply corrective training if appropriate. Inform your squad leader. Follow up.
You see another NCO correcting a Soldier in a way that crosses the line.	Step in professionally, privately if possible. Report it through the NCO support channel. Standards apply to everyone.
What's your biggest weakness?	A real weakness, plus what you're doing to fix it.
Current events LOCAL	Read the news daily this week: Army transformation, the 4ID move to an all-Stryker division, and major world events.

NCO history & duties

KNOW	The NCO Corps dates to **1775** with the Continental Army. Baron von Steuben's **"Blue Book"** (Regulations for the Order and Discipline of the Troops of the United States, 1778–79) first defined NCO duties in writing.
KNOW	The first **Sergeant Major of the Army** was **SMA William O. Wooldridge** (1966).
BONUS	The NCO Creed was written in the early 1970s at Fort Benning, as part of the NCO education system. VERIFY
KNOW	**TC 7-22.7**, The Noncommissioned Officer Guide (19 Aug 2025), is the NCO's reference for duties, responsibilities, and authority. **TC 7-21.13**, The Soldier's Guide (17 Sep 2025), is the Soldier-level reference.
KNOW	NCOs carry out the commander's intent. They lead Soldiers, train individuals and teams, maintain standards and discipline, and take care of Soldiers and their equipment.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q Who was the first Sergeant Major of the Army?	SMA William O. Wooldridge, 1966.
Q What is the "Backbone of the Army"?	The NCO Corps.
Q What is the NCO Guide?	TC 7-22.7, The Noncommissioned Officer Guide.
Q Where do you see yourself in 5 years?	A realistic goal: squad leader and SSG, ALC complete, college progress, and developing Soldiers.
Q What makes a good team leader?	Leading by example, knowing your Soldiers, enforcing standards consistently, and training your team to be ready to take your job.

5 Army Basics

Organization, ranks, the flag, and the Army's mission. A 1SG asks these when they want to see if you know the fundamentals.

ARMY MISSION MUST KNOW

"To deploy, fight, and win our Nation's wars by providing ready, prompt, and sustained land dominance by Army forces across the full spectrum of conflict as part of the joint force." VERIFY army.mil/about

Unit organization VERIFY

Unit	Typical size	Led by
Fire team	4	Team Leader (SGT)
Squad	9 (2 fire teams + SL)	Squad Leader (SSG)
Platoon	3–4 squads, about 30–45	PL (LT) / PSG (SFC)
Company	3–4 platoons, about 100–200	CPT / 1SG
Battalion	4–6 companies, about 500–900	LTC / CSM
Brigade (BCT)	About 4,000–5,000 (SBCT ≈ 4,500)	COL / CSM
Division	About 10,000–16,000	MG / CSM
Corps	2–5 divisions	LTG / CSM

In a Stryker company, the vehicle crews (driver and vehicle commander) are part of the platoon too. Know how your own platoon is organized.

Army components

KNOW Three components: **Regular Army** (active), **Army National Guard**, and **U.S. Army Reserve**.

KNOW Three types of BCT: **Infantry (IBCT)**, **Stryker (SBCT)**, and **Armored (ABCT)**.

Enlisted ranks

Grade	Rank	Abbr.
E-1	Private (no insignia)	PV1
E-2	Private	PV2
E-3	Private First Class	PFC
E-4	Specialist / Corporal	SPC / CPL
E-5	Sergeant	SGT
E-6	Staff Sergeant	SSG
E-7	Sergeant First Class	SFC
E-8	Master Sergeant / First Sergeant	MSG / 1SG
E-9	Sergeant Major / Command Sergeant Major	SGM / CSM
E-9	Sergeant Major of the Army	SMA

KNOW **The Corporal is an NCO. The Specialist is not.** They're the same pay grade (E-4).

BONUS Officers: 2LT, 1LT, CPT, MAJ, LTC, COL, BG, MG, LTG, GEN. Warrant officers: WO1, CW2–CW5.

Flag & National Anthem VERIFY

KNOW **13 stripes** stand for the original 13 colonies. **50 stars** stand for the states.

KNOW A ceremonial fold makes **13 folds** into a triangle with only the blue field showing.

KNOW **Half-staff:** raise it to the peak first, then lower it to half-staff. Raise it to the peak again before lowering it at the end of the day.

KNOW National anthem, in uniform outdoors: face the flag (or the music), stand at attention, and **salute** on the first note until the last note.

KNOW Indoors in uniform: stand at attention facing the flag or music. **No salute.**

BONUS The Army flag was dedicated on **14 June 1956**. The Army song, "The Army Goes Rolling Along," was adopted the same year.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What is the Army's mission?	To deploy, fight, and win our Nation's wars by providing ready, prompt, and sustained land dominance by Army forces across the full spectrum of conflict as part of the joint force.
Q How many Soldiers are in a fire team? A squad?	A fire team has 4. A squad has 9: the squad leader and two fire teams.
Q What's the difference between a CPL and a SPC?	Both are E-4. The CPL is an NCO with NCO authority and responsibilities. The SPC is not.
Q What are the three Army components?	Regular Army, Army National Guard, Army Reserve.
Q What does the flag stand for?	13 stripes for the original colonies. 50 stars for the states.
Q What do you do when the anthem plays outdoors and you're in uniform?	Face the flag or the music, stand at attention, and salute from the first note to the last.

6 Leadership & Counseling

As a team leader, counseling is what you do every day. Expect scenario questions.

MUST KNOW **Army leadership** is the activity of influencing people by providing purpose, direction, and motivation to accomplish the mission and improve the organization. (ADP 6-22)

MUST KNOW Attributes (what a leader IS)

C Character | **P** Presence | **I** Intellect

Character: Army Values, empathy, Warrior Ethos/service ethos, discipline, humility. Presence: military and professional bearing, fitness, confidence, resilience. Intellect: mental agility, sound judgment, innovation, interpersonal tact, expertise. VERIFY ADP 6-22 Ch 2–4

MUST KNOW Competencies (what a leader DOES)

L Leads | **D** Develops | **A** Achieves

Leads: others, builds trust, extends influence, leads by example, communicates. Develops: creates a positive environment, prepares self, develops others, stewards the profession. Achieves: gets results. VERIFY ADP 6-22 Ch 5–7

Counseling: ATP 6-22.1 (13 Feb 2024)

MUST KNOW **Three categories:** Performance, Professional Growth, Event. (Ch 2, para 2-4)

MUST KNOW **DA Form 4856**, Developmental Counseling Form, documents counseling.

KNOW **Event counseling examples:** specific instances (good or bad), reception and integration, crisis, referral, promotion, separation. VERIFY

KNOW **Three approaches:** Nondirective, Directive, Combined. VERIFY

KNOW **Four-stage counseling process:** 1) Identify the need for counseling 2) Prepare 3) Conduct the session 4) Follow up. VERIFY

KNOW **Conducting the session:** open the session, discuss the issues, develop a plan of action, record and close. VERIFY

BONUS **Counselor qualities:** respect, self-awareness and cultural awareness, credibility, empathy. VERIFY

KNOW **Local:** the 4ID **Yellow Book** (19 Feb 2026) is the local counseling SOP. It supplements Army doctrine and does not replace it.

Evaluations: AR 623-3 (14 Feb 2025)

KNOW **DA Form 2166-9-1** = NCOER for SGT. **DA Form 2166-9-1A** = NCOER Support Form. Neither one is a counseling form. **DA Pam 623-3** is the procedural pamphlet.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **Define leadership.**	Influencing people by providing purpose, direction, and motivation to accomplish the mission and improve the organization.
Q **Name the three leader attributes and the three competencies.**	Attributes: Character, Presence, Intellect. Competencies: Leads, Develops, Achieves.
Q **What are the three categories of counseling?**	Performance, professional growth, and event.
Q **What form is used for counseling? For a SGT's NCOER?**	DA Form 4856. DA Form 2166-9-1.
Q **When should you do an initial counseling?**	When a Soldier first arrives (reception and integration), and within the first 30 days of a rating period. VERIFY AR 623-3

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q **What are the levels of leadership?**	Direct, organizational, and strategic. A team leader works at the direct level. VERIFY ADP 6-22.

Q What's the difference between counseling, coaching and mentoring?	Counseling: a leader and subordinate review performance and potential. Coaching: guiding someone to improve a specific skill. Mentoring: a voluntary, long-term relationship between someone more experienced and someone less experienced, for development.
Q What should a counseling plan of action include?	Specific actions, who is responsible, and a deadline, so the Soldier knows exactly what to do to improve.
Q What is the NCOER rating chain for a SGT?	Rater, senior rater, and supplementary reviewer, if one applies. VERIFY AR 623-3.
Q What does it mean to lead by example?	Meeting every standard you enforce: PT, appearance, timeliness. Soldiers do what they see.

7 Regulations, Programs & UCMJ

Know the number and title. Board members love "What regulation covers...?"

Reg	Title	Remember
AR 600-20	Army Command Policy (15 Apr 2026)	**MUST** Ch 6 = Military Equal Opportunity
AR 600-52	SHARP Program (11 Feb 2025)	**MUST** The dedicated SHARP regulation
AR 600-92	Army Suicide Prevention Program (4 Oct 2024)	**MUST** ACE
AR 670-1 / DA Pam 670-1	Wear and Appearance of Army Uniforms and Insignia	**MUST** Ch 3 = grooming
AR 600-8-19	Enlisted Promotions and Demotions (6 Mar 2026)	**MUST** Ch 3 = semi-centralized
AR 600-9	The Army Body Composition Program	Now modified by AD 2026-13
AR 623-3	Evaluation Reporting System	NCOERs
AR 350-1	Army Training and Leader Development (1 Jun 2025)	
AR 600-85	The Army Substance Abuse Program (ASAP)	
AR 600-25	Salutes, Honors, and Courtesy (1 May 2026)	
AR 600-8-22	Military Awards (11 May 2026)	
AR 608-1	Soldier and Family Readiness (26 May 2026)	
AR 930-4	Army Emergency Relief (15 Apr 2026)	AER
AR 27-10	Military Justice (8 Jan 2025)	Article 15 procedures
AR 600-8-2	Suspension of Favorable Personnel Actions (Flags)	A flag stops promotion
AR 635-200	Active Duty Enlisted Administrative Separations (30 Jun 2025)	
AR 600-32	Conduct Between Soldiers of Different Grades (16 Sep 2024)	Fraternization and relationships
AR 385-10	The Army Safety and Occupational Health Program	
AR 621-5	Army Continuing Education System (19 Mar 2026)	TA, education center

How AR numbers work: the series NEW

The first number tells you the subject area. Knowing the series lets you reason toward the answer even when you don't remember the exact regulation. VERIFY

Series	Subject
25	Information management (25-50 correspondence)
27	Legal (27-10 Military Justice)
40	Medical (40-501 Standards of Medical Fitness)
190	Military Police (190-5 traffic, 190-11 arms security)
215	MWR

Series	Subject
600	Personnel, general (600-20, 600-52, 600-85, 600-92, 600-9)
600-8-x	Military HR (600-8-10 leave, 600-8-19 promotions, 600-8-22 awards, 600-8-2 flags)
601	Personnel procurement (601-280 retention)
608	Personal affairs (608-1, 608-18 FAP, 608-75 EFMP)
614	Assignments (614-200 enlisted)
621	Education (621-5)

350	Training (350-1)
380 / 381	Security / intelligence (381-12 threat reporting)
385	Safety (385-10, 385-63)
525	Military operations
530	Operations security (530-1)
623	Evaluations (623-3)
635	Separations (635-200 enlisted)
670	Uniforms (670-1)
672	Decorations and incentive awards (672-20)
710 / 735 / 750	Supply / property accountability / maintenance

More regulations with key subtopics NEW

Reg	Title	Subtopics worth knowing
AR 600-8-10	Leaves and Passes	Soldiers earn **2.5 days of leave per month** (30 per year). Covers emergency leave, passes and PTDY. VERIFY
AR 600-8-2	Suspension of Favorable Personnel Actions (Flags)	Flag types: **transferable** and **non-transferable**. A flag stops promotions, awards, schools, reenlistment and PCS. Initiated on **DA Form 268**. VERIFY
AR 635-200	Active Duty Enlisted Administrative Separations	Discharge characterizations: **Honorable, General (under honorable conditions), Other Than Honorable**, and uncharacterized (entry-level). **Bad Conduct and Dishonorable** come only from a court-martial. Well-known chapters: Ch 13 unsatisfactory performance, Ch 14 misconduct, Ch 10 in lieu of trial by court-martial. VERIFY
AR 600-85	Army Substance Abuse Program	Referral types: self, command, medical, biochemical (urinalysis), investigation. **Self-referral** is encouraged. VERIFY
AR 600-32 (DA Pam 600-35)	Conduct Between Soldiers of Different Grades	Covers fraternization and prohibited relationships. Relationships are improper if they compromise the chain of command, create the appearance of partiality, or involve exploitation.
AR 600-100	Army Profession and Leadership Policy	Leader development responsibilities.
AR 600-63	Army Health Promotion	Not the suicide regulation. That's AR 600-92.
AR 40-501	Standards of Medical Fitness	Profiles (DA Form 3349 permanent/temporary profile). VERIFY
AR 190-11	Physical Security of Arms, Ammunition, and Explosives	Arms rooms and weapon accountability.
AR 381-12	Threat Awareness and Reporting Program (TARP)	Report contacts, espionage indicators, insider threats.
AR 735-5	Property Accountability	Hand receipts (DA Form 2062). FLIPL (DD Form 200). Five types of responsibility: command, supervisory, direct, custodial, personal. VERIFY
AR 614-200	Enlisted Assignments and Utilization Management	Assignments, PCS and reclassification.
AR 601-280	Army Retention Program	Reenlistment and the career counselor.
AR 25-50	Preparing and Managing Correspondence	Memorandum format.

KNOW Programs

BOSS: Better Opportunities for Single Soldiers
MWR: Morale, Welfare, and Recreation
AER: Army Emergency Relief (AR 930-4). No-interest loans and grants.
ASAP: Army Substance Abuse Program (AR 600-85)
ACS: Army Community Service
EFMP: Exceptional Family Member Program (AR 608-75)
FAP: Family Advocacy Program (AR 608-18)

KNOW UCMJ basics VERIFY

Art. 15: Nonjudicial punishment. Types: summarized, company grade, field grade.
Art. 31: Rights against self-incrimination.
Courts-martial: summary, special, general.
Art. 86: AWOL. **Art. 91**: insubordinate conduct toward a warrant officer or NCO. **Art. 92**: failure to obey an order or regulation. **Art. 134**: the General Article.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **What regulation covers Army Command Policy?**	AR 600-20.
Q **What is AER?**	Army Emergency Relief. It provides financial help to Soldiers and their families. AR 930-4.
Q **What do BOSS and MWR stand for?**	Better Opportunities for Single Soldiers; Morale, Welfare, and Recreation.
Q **What does a flag do?**	It suspends favorable personnel actions such as promotion, awards, and schools. AR 600-8-2.
Q **What article of the UCMJ covers nonjudicial punishment?**	Article 15.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q **What regulation covers leave?**	AR 600-8-10. Soldiers earn 2.5 days per month.
Q **What does a flag do to promotions?**	It suspends favorable actions, including promotion. AR 600-8-2.
Q **What are the types of discharge?**	Administrative: honorable, general, other than honorable. Punitive (court-martial only): bad conduct and dishonorable.
Q **Can a Soldier be punished for self-referring to ASAP?**	Self-referral is encouraged and handled differently from command or test-based referrals. VERIFY AR 600-85 limited use policy.
Q **What article covers sexual assault?**	Article 120, UCMJ.

8 SHARP, EO & Suicide Prevention

Every board asks at least one. Precision matters: don't mix up SHARP, EO and harassment reporting.

SHARP: AR 600-52 (11 Feb 2025)

MUST KNOW Ch 2 = sexual harassment. Ch 3 = sexual assault. Ch 9 = retaliation. Para 3-3 = restricted and unrestricted reporting.

Restricted report

Confidential. **No** command notification of the victim's identity and **no** investigation. The victim gets medical care, advocacy, and counseling. Some exceptions apply. Made to a **SARC, a SHARP VA, or healthcare personnel**.
VERIFY the list in para 3-3.

Unrestricted report

Triggers **command notification and an investigation**. The victim also gets medical care, advocacy, and counseling. It can be made through the chain of command, law enforcement, a SARC, or a VA.

AS A LEADER, NEVER DO THIS

Never promise a Soldier confidentiality yourself. You are not a restricted-reporting channel. Connect them to a **SARC or SHARP Victim Advocate**, who can explain both options and the exceptions.

MUST KNOW **DA Form 7746** = Sexual Harassment Complaint (Jan 2026). **DA Form 7279** = Equal Opportunity and Harassment Complaint (Jul 2020). These are separate processes from each other and from sexual-assault reporting.

Equal Opportunity: AR 600-20, Chapter 6

KNOW A formal EO complaint uses **DA Form 7279**. Complaints can be informal or formal. **VERIFY** the current 2026 chapter text before you quote filing deadlines, protected categories, or timelines.

Suicide prevention: AR 600-92 (4 Oct 2024)

A Ask your buddy directly | **C** Care: listen, take it seriously | **E** Escort to help. Don't leave them.

MUST KNOW If a Soldier may be at **immediate risk**, stay with them, call for emergency help (911, or 988 then press 1 for the Military Crisis Line), and escort them to qualified care: Behavioral Health, the ER, or the chaplain.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What regulation covers SHARP?	AR 600-52.
Q What are the two reporting options for sexual assault?	Restricted and unrestricted. A SARC or VA explains eligibility and exceptions.
Q What form records a sexual harassment complaint?	DA Form 7746.
Q What form is used for a formal EO complaint?	DA Form 7279.
Q What does ACE stand for?	Ask, Care, Escort.
Q Who is your unit SARC/VA and EOL? LOCAL	Know the names and where the contact info is posted on the company board.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q Who can take a restricted report?	A SARC, a SHARP VA, or healthcare personnel. **VERIFY** AR 600-52 para 3-3.
Q What is retaliation?	Taking or threatening adverse action, ostracism or maltreatment against someone for reporting. It's prohibited. AR 600-52 Ch 9.

Q Who is your SHARP representative?	Know your SARC and VA by name and where their info is posted. LOCAL
Q What are the warning signs of suicide?	Talking about death or hopelessness, giving away possessions, withdrawing, increased alcohol use, sudden mood changes, and relationship, legal or financial trouble.

9 Wear & Appearance

You're wearing the subject of these questions. Be ready to be tested on your own uniform.

MUST KNOW **AR 670-1**, Wear and Appearance of Army Uniforms and Insignia. **DA Pam 670-1** is the detailed wear guide. **AR 670-1 Chapter 3** covers appearance and grooming.

MUST KNOW **Facial hair:** Army Directives **2025-13** and **2026-09**. Male Soldiers are **clean-shaven** in uniform or on duty unless an approved medical exception or religious accommodation applies. Authorized mustaches are still permitted. An existing approved religious accommodation stays valid during its required review.

KNOW **Army Directive 2025-18** also updated grooming and appearance. For any specific hairstyle, jewelry, tattoo, or uniform question, check the AR, DA Pam, directive, and 4ID Green Book together.

KNOW **4ID Green Book** (9 Apr 2026): local tactical uniform standards, **Ivy Duty / Ivy Light / Ivy Ready**. Ivy Ready requires **two tourniquets** and an accessible issued IFAK in training and operations.

KNOW **AGSU:** ribbons centered 1/8 inch above the left breast pocket of the coat, right to left by precedence, no more than 4 per row. No ribbons on the AGSU shirt. No miniature badges. **VERIFY** DA Pam 670-1.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What is the regulation for wear and appearance?	AR 670-1, with wear details in DA Pam 670-1.
Q What chapter of AR 670-1 covers grooming?	Chapter 3.
Q What is the facial hair standard?	Clean-shaven in uniform or on duty unless an approved medical exception or religious accommodation applies.
Q Where do ribbons go on your AGSU coat?	Centered 1/8 inch above the left breast pocket, highest precedence on the wearer's right.
Q What are the three 4ID tactical uniform configurations?	Ivy Duty, Ivy Light, Ivy Ready (4ID Green Book).

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q Where is the nameplate worn on your AGSU?	Know the exact answer from DA Pam 670-1 for your uniform and be ready to show it. **LOCAL**
Q Can Soldiers wear wireless earbuds in uniform?	Check the current AR 670-1 and Army Directive updates. Don't answer from memory. **VERIFY**
Q Who is responsible for a Soldier's appearance?	The Soldier first, then first-line leaders who inspect and correct.

10 Promotions, Awards & ABCP

You're at a promotion board. Know the process you're in.

Promotions: AR 600-8-19 (6 Mar 2026)

MUST KNOW Chapter 3 covers **semi-centralized promotions** (SGT and SSG). Para 3-8 covers unit promotion boards. Para 3-12 covers board proceedings.

KNOW **SGT eligibility** per the HQDA cutoff-score memo (Feb 2026). Primary zone: **34 months TIS / 10 months TIG**. Secondary zone: **18 months TIS / 6 months TIG**. The 2026 revision removed waivers for secondary-zone requirements. VERIFY AR 600-8-19 Table 3-1.

KNOW **BLC** is not required to appear before a SGT board. It is required to appear before an SSG board. The March 2026 update changed how BLC/ALC promotion points are awarded. VERIFY

BONUS Promotion points fall into categories: military training (weapons qualification, fitness), awards and decorations, military education, and civilian education. Check your points in IPPS-A. VERIFY category maximums.

KNOW **AR 600-8-22**, Military Awards (11 May 2026). Don't quote approval authorities from 2025 guidance.

Army Body Composition Program: Army Directive 2026-13

THE 2026 RULE: WAIST-TO-HEIGHT ONLY

Waist circumference (at the navel) ÷ height (inches). Truncate after 3 decimals. Don't round.
Less than 0.550 = PASS. 0.550 or more = FAIL.
A second, different team confirms an initial failure the same duty day. Record it on **DA Form 5500**. DA Form 5501 is no longer used. **A high AFT score does not exempt you.**

Example	Math	Result
34.5 in waist, 70 in tall	34.5 ÷ 70 = 0.4928...→ 0.492	PASS
38.5 in waist, 70 in tall	38.5 ÷ 70 = 0.5500 → 0.550	FAIL

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What regulation covers enlisted promotions?	AR 600-8-19, Enlisted Promotions and Demotions.
Q What is the ABCP pass standard?	Waist divided by height must be less than 0.550. 0.550 fails. (AD 2026-13)
Q Does a high AFT score exempt a Soldier from ABCP?	No.
Q What form records the body composition assessment?	DA Form 5500.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q What's the difference between the primary and secondary zone?	The primary zone has longer TIS and TIG requirements. The secondary zone lets top performers be recommended earlier, at the commander's discretion.
Q What system tracks promotion points now?	IPPS-A, the Integrated Personnel and Pay System–Army. VERIFY
Q What is the highest award for valor?	The Medal of Honor.
Q What form is a recommendation for award?	DA Form 638. VERIFY

11 H2F, AFT & CFT

2026 is a transition year. Answer the annual framework and the transition rule together.

MUST KNOW **FM 7-22**, Holistic Health and Fitness (1 Oct 2020, incl. C2). **Five domains:** Physical, Nutritional, Mental, Spiritual, Sleep Readiness.

P Physical | **N** Nutritional | **M** Mental | **S** Spiritual | **S** Sleep

MUST KNOW AFT: 5 events

1. 3-Repetition Maximum **Deadlift** (MDL)
2. **Hand-Release Push-Up** (HRP)
3. **Sprint-Drag-Carry** (SDC)
4. **Plank** (PLK)
5. **Two-Mile Run** (2MR)

Replaced the ACFT on 1 Jun 2025. **Combat standard (11B): 350 total, minimum 60 per event, sex-neutral.** Enforced for the Regular Army since 1 Jan 2026. VERIFY ATP 7-22.01.

MUST KNOW CFT: 7 continuous events

1. 1-mile run
2. 30 dead-stop push-ups
3. 100-meter sprint
4. 16 × 40-lb sandbag lifts to 65 inches
5. Two 40-lb water cans, 50 meters
6. 25 m high crawl + 25 m rush
7. 1-mile run

Pass/fail on total time. The Army FAQ says 30 minutes or less. VERIFY uniform and event details in the directive.

ARMY DIRECTIVE 2026-07 (17 APR 2026): APPLIES TO 11B

Annual framework for active-duty combat specialties: **one CFT and one AFT per year, at least four months apart.**
Year one is an implementation period: no adverse administrative action solely for a CFT failure. Full implementation is 365 days after the directive.
So in November 2026, a CFT failure **alone** does not trigger adverse action.

PRT drills: ATP 7-22.02 (1 Oct 2020, incl. C1)

MUST KNOW Preparation Drill (Ch 3, para 3-1)

1. Bend and Reach
2. Rear Lunge
3. High Jumper
4. Rower
5. Squat Bender
6. Windmill
7. Forward Lunge
8. Prone Row
9. Bent-Leg Body Twist
10. Push-Up

MUST KNOW Recovery Drill (Ch 16)

1. Overhead Arm Pull
2. Rear Lunge
3. Extend and Flex
4. Thigh Stretch
5. Single-Leg Over
6. **Groin Stretch** FIXED
7. **Calf Stretch** FIXED
8. Hamstring Stretch

BOARD ANSWERS

Q Name the five H2F domains.	Physical, nutritional, mental, spiritual, and sleep readiness.
Q Name the five AFT events.	Deadlift, hand-release push-up, sprint-drag-carry, plank, two-mile run.
Q What's the AFT combat standard?	350 total points with at least 60 on each event.
Q Does a CFT failure in November 2026 trigger adverse action?	Not on its own. AD 2026-07 gives a one-year implementation period from 17 Apr 2026.
Q What are the last three exercises of the Recovery Drill?	Groin Stretch, Calf Stretch, Hamstring Stretch.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q What does H2F stand for?	Holistic Health and Fitness.
Q What are the first three Preparation Drill exercises?	Bend and Reach, Rear Lunge, High Jumper.
Q What does the AFT minimum per event mean for you?	As 11B, I need at least 60 on each event and 350 total under the combat standard.
Q Who is on the H2F performance team?	Strength coaches, athletic trainers, physical therapists, dietitians, and cognitive performance specialists. VERIFY

12 Benefits & Resilience

A team leader sends Soldiers to the right resource. Boards check that you know what's available.

DOLLAR AMOUNTS CHANGE

Education caps, TSP matching and insurance amounts change by fiscal year and policy. The structure below is stable, but confirm dollar figures with the education center, finance or ArmyIgnitED before you quote them.

Education

KNOW Tuition Assistance (TA)

Pays tuition for off-duty college courses through **ArmyIgnitED**. It has a per-credit-hour cap and an annual cap. Governed by **AR 621-5**, the Army Continuing Education System. Start at the installation **Education Center**.

KNOW Credentialing Assistance (CA)

Pays for civilian certifications and licenses related to your career, also through ArmyIgnitED.

KNOW GI Bill

The **Post-9/11 GI Bill** pays for education after qualifying service. It can be transferred to dependents if you meet the service requirements.

BONUS SkillBridge

Civilian job training during your last 180 days of service, with commander approval.

Pay, retirement & insurance

KNOW **BRS (Blended Retirement System):** the Government puts in 1% automatically and matches your **Thrift Savings Plan (TSP)** contributions up to 4% more, for **5% total** when you contribute 5%. It also includes a pension after 20 years and continuation pay mid-career. VERIFY

KNOW **SGLI (Servicemembers' Group Life Insurance):** low-cost life insurance, maximum **$500,000**. Keep your beneficiaries current through **SOES**. VERIFY

KNOW **AER (Army Emergency Relief):** no-interest loans and grants for emergencies such as rent, car repair or emergency travel. AR 930-4.

Support resources

Resource	What it does
ACS (Army Community Service)	Financial readiness, relocation, EFMP, family advocacy, employment readiness
Chaplain / Unit Ministry Team	Spiritual support and confidential counseling (privileged communication)
Behavioral Health (Embedded BH)	Mental health care. Self-referral is encouraged.
MFLC (Military & Family Life Counselor)	Short-term, non-medical counseling. No records kept.
Military OneSource	24/7 phone and online counseling, tax help and resources
ASAP (Army Substance Abuse Program)	Prevention and treatment. AR 600-85.
Military Crisis Line	Dial **988, then press 1**
BOSS / MWR	Single Soldier programs. Recreation and quality-of-life activities.

Resilience: Master Resilience Training (MRT) VERIFY

KNOW Six MRT competencies

1. Self-Awareness
2. Self-Regulation
3. Optimism
4. Mental Agility
5. Strengths of Character
6. Connection

KNOW Core MRT skills

Hunt the Good Stuff · **ATC** (Activating event → Thoughts → Consequences) · Avoid Thinking Traps · Detect Icebergs · Energy Management · Problem Solving · Put It in Perspective · Real-Time Resilience · Character Strengths · Assertive Communication · Active Constructive Responding · Effective Praise

BONUS The Army's resilience program is **R2** (Ready and Resilient). MRT is part of it, and so are the **H2F** mental and spiritual domains.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q A Soldier wants to start college. Where do you send them?	To the Education Center to set up Tuition Assistance through ArmyIgnitED. It's governed by AR 621-5.
Q What does the government contribute under BRS?	1% automatically, plus matching up to 5% total when the Soldier contributes 5% to the TSP.
Q What's the maximum SGLI coverage?	$500,000.
Q What does ATC stand for in MRT?	Activating event, Thoughts, Consequences.
Q Name the six MRT competencies.	Self-awareness, self-regulation, optimism, mental agility, strengths of character, connection.
Q Where can a Soldier get confidential counseling with no records?	The chaplain (privileged communication) or an MFLC.

13 Training, Risk Management & CBRN

Sergeants plan and run training. The board wants to see you can do it safely and to standard.

8-Step Training Model MUST KNOW

1. Plan the training
2. Train and certify leaders
3. Recon the training site
4. Issue the order
5. Rehearse
6. Execute
7. Conduct an After Action Review (AAR)
8. Retrain

VERIFY FM 7-0, Training (14 Jun 2021). ADP 7-0 covers training principles. AR 350-1 is the training regulation.

After Action Review KNOW

1. What was supposed to happen?
2. What happened?
3. Why did it happen?
4. What do we sustain, and what do we improve?

KNOW AARs can be **formal** or **informal**. They focus on performance against the standard, not on blaming people.

KNOW **Crawl–Walk–Run:** learn the task, practice it, then perform it under realistic conditions.

BONUS **METL** = Mission Essential Task List: the tasks the unit must be able to do for its mission. Task proficiency ratings: **T** (trained), **P** (practiced), **U** (untrained). VERIFY FM 7-0.

Risk Management: ATP 5-19 MUST KNOW

1. Identify the hazards
2. Assess the hazards
3. Develop controls and make risk decisions
4. Implement controls
5. Supervise and evaluate

KNOW Document it on **DD Form 2977**, the Deliberate Risk Assessment Worksheet. Risk levels: **Extremely High, High, Medium, Low**. VERIFY

KNOW Safety program: **AR 385-10**. Range safety: **AR 385-63**.

OPSEC: AR 530-1

KNOW **OPSEC** = Operations Security: protecting critical information from adversaries. That includes social media, unit movements, photos, and duty schedules.

BONUS OPSEC process: identify critical information, analyze threats, analyze vulnerabilities, assess risk, apply countermeasures. VERIFY

CBRN: FM 3-11 (10 Apr 2025)

KNOW **CBRN** = Chemical, Biological, Radiological, and Nuclear.

MOPP level VERIFY	Overgarment	Boots	Mask	Gloves
MOPP Ready	Gear is within 2 hours of reach			
MOPP 0	Gear is carried or immediately available. Nothing is worn.			
MOPP 1	Worn	Carried	Carried	Carried
MOPP 2	Worn	Worn	Carried	Carried
MOPP 3	Worn	Worn	Worn	Carried
MOPP 4	Worn	Worn	Worn	Worn

KNOW **MOPP** = Mission Oriented Protective Posture. If you suspect a chemical attack: **stop breathing, put on your mask, clear and check it, give the alarm "GAS, GAS, GAS"**, then go to MOPP 4. You have 9 seconds to mask. VERIFY

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **Name the 8-step training model.**	Plan; train and certify leaders; recon the site; issue the order; rehearse; execute; conduct the AAR; retrain.

Q What are the four parts of an AAR?	What was supposed to happen, what happened, why it happened, and what to sustain or improve.
Q What are the five steps of risk management?	Identify hazards; assess hazards; develop controls and make risk decisions; implement controls; supervise and evaluate.
Q What form documents a deliberate risk assessment?	DD Form 2977.
Q What do you wear in MOPP 4?	Everything: overgarment, boots, mask and gloves.
Q What regulation covers OPSEC?	AR 530-1.

14 Infantry Tactics & the Stryker

You're an 11B team leader and former driver. Expect the 1SGs to go deep here.

Troop Leading Procedures: ATP 3-21.8 para 2-16

1. Receive the mission
2. Issue a warning order (WARNORD)
3. Make a tentative plan
4. Initiate movement
5. Conduct reconnaissance
6. Complete the plan
7. Issue the order
8. Supervise and refine

Five-paragraph OPORD: para 2-113

S Situation | **M** Mission | **E** Execution | **S** Sustainment | **C** Command & Signal

The **mission statement** answers who, what, when, where, and why.

METT-TC (I)

Mission · **E**nemy · **T**errain and weather · **T**roops and support available · **T**ime available · **C**ivil considerations · **(I)** informational considerations, integrated into the other variables.

OAKOC: terrain analysis (para 2-63)

Observation and fields of fire · **A**venues of approach · **K**ey terrain · **O**bstacles · **C**over and concealment

SALUTE: spot report (para 1-25)

Size · **A**ctivity · **L**ocation · **U**nit FIXED · **T**ime · **E**quipment

Movement & patrolling

Technique (para 3-75)	When
Traveling	Contact unlikely
Traveling overwatch	Contact possible
Bounding overwatch	Contact expected

KNOW **Five principles of patrolling:** Planning, Reconnaissance, Security, Control, Common Sense. ATP 3-21.8 **Chapter 7** covers patrols. Section III covers combat patrols: raids, ambushes, and security patrols.

KNOW **Engagement area development (7 steps):** identify enemy avenues of approach, determine the enemy scheme of maneuver, decide where to kill the enemy, integrate obstacles, emplace weapons systems, integrate indirect fires, rehearse.

Team leader tools NEW

Fire team

4 Soldiers: **Team Leader, Automatic Rifleman, Grenadier, Rifleman.** The TL leads by example: "Follow me and do as I do." VERIFY

Fire command: ADDRAC

Alert · **D**irection · **D**escription · **R**ange · **A**ssignment/method of fire · **C**ommand to open fire VERIFY

Contingency plan: GOTWA

Going · **O**thers you're taking · **T**ime you'll be gone · **W**hat to do if you don't return · **A**ctions on contact

LACE report

Liquid · **A**mmunition · **C**asualties · **E**quipment. Sent up after contact or during consolidation.

Fire team formations

Wedge (basic) and **file**. Squad formations: column, line, file. VERIFY

Battle drills

React to contact · Break contact · React to ambush (near/far) · Knock out a bunker · Enter and clear a room · Enter a trench. VERIFY current list in ATP 3-21.8.

The Stryker (ICVV) NEW

KNOW	**ATP 3-21.9**, Stryker Infantry Rifle Platoon and Squad (24 Jun 2025), is the Stryker companion to ATP 3-21.8.
KNOW	**ICVV** = Infantry Carrier Vehicle, **Double V-Hull** (M1256). It's the DVH version of the M1126 ICV. The V-shaped hull deflects IED blast. Crew of **2 (driver and vehicle commander)**, carrying a **9-Soldier infantry squad**. Armed with a Remote Weapon Station (M2 .50 cal or Mk 19). VERIFY TM and unit config.
KNOW	**PMCS:** Before, During, After, Weekly, Monthly, per the vehicle's -10 operator TM. Faults go on **DA Form 5988-E**. Maintenance policy is in **DA Pam 750-1** (29 Apr 2026). VERIFY

USE YOUR EXPERIENCE

You were a driver. If you're asked about the Stryker, talk about PMCS, dispatch, the 5988-E, and ground guides. "I've been a driver" is a strong answer when you can show you know the standard.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **List the eight TLPs.**	Receive the mission; issue a WARNORD; make a tentative plan; initiate movement; conduct reconnaissance; complete the plan; issue the order; supervise and refine.
Q **What are the five paragraphs of an OPORD?**	Situation, Mission, Execution, Sustainment, Command and Signal.
Q **When do you use bounding overwatch?**	When enemy contact is expected.
Q **What does the U in SALUTE stand for?**	Unit.
Q **What is a WARNORD?**	A warning order gives subordinates early information so they can start preparing.
Q **What ATP covers the Stryker platoon and squad?**	ATP 3-21.9.
Q **What's the form for recording vehicle faults?**	DA Form 5988-E.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q **What are the four steps of a battle drill react to contact?**	React, locate, suppress, and then the leader decides to assault, flank or break contact. VERIFY ATP 3-21.8.
Q **What's the difference between cover and concealment?**	Cover protects you from fire. Concealment only hides you from observation.
Q **What are the three types of patrols?**	Combat, reconnaissance, and security patrols. VERIFY
Q **What are the forms of maneuver?**	Envelopment, flank attack, frontal attack, infiltration, penetration, turning movement. VERIFY ADP 3-90.
Q **What is a team leader's role in a Stryker squad dismount?**	Control the fire team, keep it in formation and contact, and execute the squad leader's plan.

15 Infantry Acronyms

If a 1SG says "What's an ORP?", give the full term and one line on what it's for.

HOW TO ANSWER

"First Sergeant, ORP stands for Objective Rally Point. It's a point out of sight, sound and small-arms range of the objective, where the unit makes final preparations before actions on the objective."

Control measures & graphics

Term	Meaning
AA	Assembly Area
AO	Area of Operations
ABF	Attack by Fire (position)
SBF	Support by Fire (position)
BP	Battle Position
EA	Engagement Area
LD	Line of Departure
LOA	Limit of Advance
PL	Phase Line
PLD	Probable Line of Deployment
OBJ	Objective
ORP	Objective Rally Point
RP	Release Point (or Rally Point)
SP	Start Point
TRP	Target Reference Point
FPL	Final Protective Line
FPF	Final Protective Fire
NAI	Named Area of Interest
LP / OP	Listening Post / Observation Post
LZ / PZ	Landing Zone / Pickup Zone
MSR	Main Supply Route
CP	Command Post (or Checkpoint)
FLOT	Forward Line of Own Troops
FEBA	Forward Edge of the Battle Area

Orders, planning & intel

Term	Meaning
TLP	Troop Leading Procedures
OPORD	Operation Order
WARNORD	Warning Order
FRAGORD	Fragmentary Order: a change to an existing order
CONOP	Concept of the Operation
COA	Course of Action
CCIR	Commander's Critical Information Requirements
PIR	Priority Intelligence Requirements
FFIR	Friendly Force Information Requirements
EEFI	Essential Elements of Friendly Information
ROE	Rules of Engagement
SOI	Signal Operating Instructions
PCC / PCI	Pre-Combat Checks / Pre-Combat Inspections
QRF	Quick Reaction Force
ISR	Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance
BMNT	Beginning of Morning Nautical Twilight
EENT	End of Evening Nautical Twilight
TTP	Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Casualties & reports

Term	Meaning
CASEVAC	Casualty Evacuation (non-medical vehicle)
MEDEVAC	Medical Evacuation (dedicated medical platform)
CCP	Casualty Collection Point
KIA / WIA	Killed / Wounded in Action
EPW	Enemy Prisoner of War. Handle with the **5 S's and T**: Search, Silence, Segregate, Safeguard, Speed to the rear, Tag. VERIFY
IED / UXO	Improvised Explosive Device / Unexploded Ordnance
LACE	Liquid, Ammunition, Casualties, Equipment
SALUTE	Size, Activity, Location, Unit, Time, Equipment

Memory aids

METT-TC (I)

Mission, Enemy, Terrain & weather, Troops & support available, Time, Civil considerations, Informational considerations

OAKOC

Observation & fields of fire, Avenues of approach, Key terrain, Obstacles, Cover & concealment

GOTWA

Going, Others, Time, What if I don't return, Actions on contact

ADDRAC

Alert, Direction, Description, Range, Assignment, Control (command to fire)

MARCH

Massive hemorrhage, Airway, Respiration, Circulation, Hypothermia/Head

SMEAC

Situation, Mission, Execution, Admin/Sustainment, Command & Signal: the 5-paragraph OPORD

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What is an ORP?	Objective Rally Point. It's where the unit halts out of sight, sound and small-arms range of the objective to make final preparations.
Q What's the difference between CASEVAC and MEDEVAC?	MEDEVAC uses a dedicated medical platform with medical care en route. CASEVAC uses any available, non-medical vehicle.
Q What is a FRAGORD?	A fragmentary order, which changes an existing order.
Q What does LD stand for?	Line of Departure. It's where the attack begins and is crossed at a set time.
Q What are PCCs and PCIs?	Pre-combat checks and pre-combat inspections. Leaders confirm Soldiers and equipment are ready before the mission.
Q What is an FPL?	A Final Protective Line: the line where a machine gun's grazing fire stops an enemy assault.

16 Weapons: M4/ACOG, M320, M249, M240B

Your weapon, your old weapons, and the platoon's guns. Expect "tell me about your weapon."

NUMBERS COME WITH A CAVEAT

Range, rate, and weight figures change with the weapon variant, ammunition, and mount. The figures below are the standard published ones. Check them against the TC on your issued system. If a board member's number differs, say: **"First Sergeant, per TC 3-22.9 for my weapon, it's... I'll confirm against the TC."**

Shot process: TC 3-22.9

MUST KNOW Four functional elements

- **S** Stability
- **A** Aim
- **C** Control
- **M** Movement

MUST KNOW Three phases

- **1** Pre-shot
- **2** Shot
- **3** Post-shot

MUST KNOW **Four weapon safety rules:** 1) Treat every weapon as loaded. 2) Never point a weapon at anything you don't intend to shoot. 3) Keep your finger straight and off the trigger until you're ready to fire. 4) Keep the weapon on safe until you intend to fire. VERIFY TC 3-22.9.

KNOW **Cycle of function (8 steps):** Feeding, Chambering, Locking, Firing, Unlocking, Extracting, Ejecting, Cocking.

Weapon data VERIFY

Weapon	Reference	Max effective (point)	Max effective (area)	Max range	Notes
M4/M4A1 carbine (yours)	TC 3-22.9	500 m	600 m	3,600 m	5.56 mm. Gas-operated, air-cooled, magazine-fed, shoulder-fired.
M320 grenade launcher	TC 3-22.31	150 m	350 m	400 m	40 mm low-velocity. Round arms roughly 14–38 m from the muzzle.
M249 SAW	TC 3-22.249	600 m bipod / 800 m tripod	800 m bipod / 1,000 m tripod	3,600 m	5.56 mm, belt- or magazine-fed.
M240B	TC 3-22.240	800 m (tripod)	1,800 m (tripod)	3,725 m	7.62 mm, **27.1 lb** (Table 2-1). MUST in your old notes, already checked.

KNOW Your optic: ACOG / M150 RCO

M150 Rifle Combat Optic (Trijicon ACOG). **4× magnification.** Has an illuminated chevron reticle and a **bullet drop compensator** with stadia lines for ranges out to 800 m. Know how you zero it and the dimensions you zero at. VERIFY TC 3-22.9 optic chapter and the unit's zero standard.

KNOW Malfunctions

Know **immediate action** and **remedial action** as written in your current TC. Don't recite older acronyms like "SPORTS" unless you know your TC still uses them. Be ready to say what a stoppage, malfunction, and misfire are. VERIFY TC 3-22.9.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q Name the four functional elements of the shot process.	Stability, aim, control, and movement.
Q What are the three phases of the shot process?	Pre-shot, shot, and post-shot.
Q What is the max effective range of the M4 for a point target?	500 meters (area 600 m), per TC 3-22.9. VERIFY
Q How much does the M240B weigh?	27.1 pounds, per TC 3-22.240 Table 2-1.
Q Why verify a range figure against the platform?	Because it varies with weapon variant, firing support (bipod or tripod), ammunition, and configuration.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q What are the four rules of weapon safety?	Treat every weapon as loaded; never point it at anything you don't intend to shoot; keep your finger off the trigger until ready to fire; keep the weapon on safe until you intend to fire.
Q What are the 8 steps of the cycle of function?	Feeding, chambering, locking, firing, unlocking, extracting, ejecting, cocking.
Q What magnification is your ACOG?	4x (M150 RCO).
Q Tell me about your weapon.	M4 carbine, 5.56 mm, gas-operated, air-cooled, magazine-fed, shoulder-fired. 500 m point, 600 m area. Your optic and zero. TC 3-22.9.

17 Infantry Weapon Systems

Every weapon in an infantry company and a Stryker battalion. Know what each is for and its basic numbers.

ALL FIGURES: VERIFY AGAINST THE TC OR TM

These are standard published figures, and they vary by model, mount and round. On the board, give the reference along with the number. If you aren't sure: "First Sergeant, I'd confirm that in TC ___."

Small arms & machine guns

System	Caliber	Max effective range	Max range	Key facts
M4 / M4A1 carbine	5.56 mm	500 m point / 600 m area	3,600 m	TC 3-22.9
M17 / M18 pistol (MHS)	9 mm	50 m	—	Modular Handgun System, replaced the M9
XM7 rifle (NGSW)	6.8 mm	—	—	Next Generation Squad Weapon, being fielded to replace the M4 in close-combat units. Know if your unit has it.
M249 SAW	5.56 mm	600 m point / 800 m area (bipod)	3,600 m	TC 3-22.249. Belt- or magazine-fed.
XM250 (NGSW-AR)	6.8 mm	—	—	Automatic rifle replacing the M249 in some units
M110A1 SDMR	7.62 mm	About 600 m	—	Squad Designated Marksman Rifle
M240B / L MMG	7.62 mm	800 m point / 1,800 m area (tripod)	3,725 m	TC 3-22.240. M240B weighs 27.1 lb. The M240L is lighter.
M2A1 .50 cal HMG	.50 cal (12.7 mm)	About 1,830 m (area)	About 6,800 m	"Ma Deuce." Mounted in the Stryker RWS.

Grenades, launchers & anti-armor

System	Type	Effective range	Key facts
M320	40 mm grenade launcher	150 m point / 350 m area	TC 3-22.31. Max range about 400 m.
Mk 19	40 mm automatic grenade launcher	About 1,500 m point / 2,212 m area	Belt-fed, high-velocity 40 mm. Mounted in the Stryker RWS.
M67	Fragmentation hand grenade	Throw about 40 m	Kill radius 5 m, casualty radius 15 m. Fuze delay 4–5 seconds.
M18A1 Claymore	Directional anti-personnel mine	About 50 m optimum	About 700 steel balls in a 60° fan. Danger area to the rear. "FRONT TOWARD ENEMY."
M136 AT4	84 mm, single-shot, disposable	About 300 m	Light anti-armor and bunker weapon. Watch the backblast area.
M3 / M3E1 MAAWS	84 mm recoilless rifle (Carl Gustaf)	Up to about 1,000 m by round	Reusable. Multiple round types: HEAT, HE, smoke, illumination.
FGM-148 Javelin	Anti-tank guided missile	About 2,500 m (longer with the newer CLU)	"Fire and forget." **Top-attack** and **direct-attack** modes. Has a CLU (Command Launch Unit).
TOW	Wire-guided anti-tank missile	About 3,750 m	Tube-launched, Optically tracked, Wire-guided. On some Stryker ATGM vehicles.

Mortars (indirect fire)

System	Caliber	Where

M224	60 mm	Company
M252	81 mm	Battalion
M120 / M121	120 mm	Battalion. The **M121** mounts in the Stryker Mortar Carrier Vehicle (MCV).

Stryker family

Variant	Role
ICV / ICVV	Infantry Carrier Vehicle, double V-hull (M1256). Carries a 9-Soldier squad. Crew of 2.
ICV-D "Dragoon"	ICV with a 30 mm cannon
MCV	Mortar Carrier Vehicle (120 mm)
ATGM	Anti-Tank Guided Missile vehicle (TOW)
CV	Commander's Vehicle
FSV	Fire Support Vehicle
ESV	Engineer Squad Vehicle
MEV	Medical Evacuation Vehicle
RV	Reconnaissance Vehicle
NBCRV	Nuclear, Biological, Chemical Reconnaissance Vehicle

LOCAL Know which variants your battalion actually has, and whether your ICVs carry the M2 or the Mk 19.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What are the two attack modes of the Javelin?	Top attack and direct attack.
Q What does TOW stand for?	Tube-launched, Optically tracked, Wire-guided.
Q What is the kill radius of an M67 grenade?	5 meters. The casualty radius is 15 meters.
Q What is written on the front of a Claymore?	"FRONT TOWARD ENEMY."
Q What mortar does the Stryker MCV carry?	The M121 120 mm mortar.
Q What's the max effective range of the AT4?	About 300 meters.

18 Communications & Maintenance

A team leader keeps the radio working and the vehicle up. As a former driver, this is ground you can own.

Phonetic alphabet MUST KNOW

A Alpha	**B** Bravo	**C** Charlie	**D** Delta	**E** Echo	**F** Foxtrot	**G** Golf	**H** Hotel	**I** India	**J** Juliett
K Kilo	**L** Lima	**M** Mike	**N** November	**O** Oscar	**P** Papa	**Q** Quebec	**R** Romeo	**S** Sierra	**T** Tango
U Uniform	**V** Victor	**W** Whiskey	**X** X-ray	**Y** Yankee	**Z** Zulu				

Numbers are spoken digit by digit. Nine is "**niner**."

Prowords KNOW

Proword	Meaning
OVER	My transmission is ended and I expect a response.
OUT	My transmission is ended and I expect no response.
ROGER	I have received your last transmission satisfactorily.
WILCO	I have received your message, understand it, and will comply.
SAY AGAIN	Repeat all of your last transmission. (Never "repeat," which is an artillery term.)
I SAY AGAIN	I'm repeating my transmission.
BREAK	I'm separating parts of the message.
WAIT / WAIT OUT	Pause a few seconds / I'll call you back.
CORRECTION	I made an error. The correct version follows.
RADIO CHECK	What is my signal strength and readability?

NEVER SAY "OVER AND OUT"

OVER asks for a reply. OUT ends with no reply. Together they contradict each other.

Radios VERIFY

KNOW **SINCGARS** = Single Channel Ground and Airborne Radio System. VHF-FM, frequency hopping. Being replaced by newer handheld and manpack radios such as the AN/PRC-163 and AN/PRC-117G.

KNOW **SOI** (Signal Operating Instructions) give the frequencies, call signs, challenge and password.

KNOW **PACE plan:** Primary, Alternate, Contingency, Emergency methods of communication.

KNOW **Radio check reply:** "Lima Charlie" means Loud and Clear.

BONUS **COMSEC** = Communications Security. Never send classified or sensitive info in the clear.

LOCAL Know the radios in your vehicle and your platoon's call signs.

Maintenance

MUST KNOW **PMCS** = Preventive Maintenance Checks and Services. Intervals: **Before, During, After** operation, plus **Weekly** and **Monthly**. Done from the operator's **-10 TM**.

KNOW **DA Form 5988-E** = Equipment Maintenance and Inspection Worksheet, generated from GCSS-Army. **DA Form 2404** = the manual version.

KNOW **Deadline (NMC):** a fault that makes the vehicle Not Mission Capable. It can't be dispatched until fixed.

KNOW **Dispatch:** PMCS done, faults recorded, a licensed operator, and a dispatch issued before the vehicle moves.

KNOW **Two maintenance levels: Field** (operator/crew and unit maintainers) and **Sustainment** (depot and repair-and-return). VERIFY DA Pam 750-1.

KNOW **GCSS-Army** = Global Combat Support System–Army: the system for maintenance and supply.

KNOW **Ground guides:** required when backing up, in motor pools, in assembly areas, and in congested areas. Two ground guides for tracked or large vehicles when backing. VERIFY unit SOP.

KNOW **Property: DA Form 2062** = hand receipt. **DD Form 200** = Financial Liability Investigation of Property Loss (FLIPL). Policy: **AR 735-5**.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **What does PMCS stand for, and what are the intervals?**	Preventive Maintenance Checks and Services. Before, during, after, weekly, and monthly.
Q **What form is used to record faults?**	DA Form 5988-E. DA Form 2404 is the manual version.
Q **What's the difference between ROGER and WILCO?**	ROGER means I received it. WILCO means I received it, understand it, and will comply.
Q **What does PACE stand for?**	Primary, Alternate, Contingency, Emergency.
Q **What is a hand receipt?**	DA Form 2062. It shows who is responsible for property.
Q **What does SINCGARS stand for?**	Single Channel Ground and Airborne Radio System.

19 First Aid, TCCC & 9-Line

Your 1SGs will expect a team leader to know how to keep a Soldier alive.

MUST KNOW **ATP 4-02.11**, Casualty Response, Tactical Combat Casualty Care, and First Aid (23 Mar 2026). It **superseded TC 4-02.1**.

1 · Care Under Fire

Return fire and win the fight. Move the casualty to cover. Direct them to self-aid. A tourniquet for life-threatening extremity bleeding is the only treatment under fire. **VERIFY**

2 · Tactical Field Care

You're no longer under effective fire. Assess and treat with **MARCH**. **VERIFY**

3 · Tactical Evacuation Care

Care while the casualty is moved to a higher level of care. **FIXED** This is not the "evac plan."

M Massive hemorrhage	**A** Airway	**R** Respiration	**C** Circulation	**H** Hypothermia / Head injury

MARCH is the standard TCCC assessment sequence. **VERIFY** against ATP 4-02.11 and your unit's medical training.

MEDICAL ANSWERS FOLLOW CURRENT MEDICAL TRAINING

Don't work out a treatment from a mnemonic. Rehearse IFAK contents and casualty transfer with your platoon medic. Know where your IFAK and both tourniquets are on your kit (4ID Ivy Ready).

9-Line MEDEVAC request **VERIFY**

Line	Content	Line	Content
1	Location of pickup site (grid)	6	Security at pickup site (wartime) / Number and type of wound (peacetime)
2	Radio frequency, call sign, suffix	7	Method of marking the pickup site
3	Number of patients by precedence	8	Patient nationality and status
4	Special equipment required	9	CBRN contamination (wartime) / Terrain description (peacetime)
5	Number of patients by type (litter / ambulatory)		

Precedence	Evacuate within
A – Urgent	1 hour
B – Urgent-Surgical	1 hour
C – Priority	4 hours
D – Routine	24 hours
E – Convenience	As convenient

Your old guide held back the exact 9-line wording pending source checks. These are the long-standing lines and precedence categories. Check them against ATP 4-02.11 or the unit SOI before you recite them as the 2026 standard.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q What replaced TC 4-02.1?	ATP 4-02.11, Casualty Response, Tactical Combat Casualty Care, and First Aid.
Q Name the three phases of TCCC.	Care Under Fire, Tactical Field Care, Tactical Evacuation Care.
Q What does MARCH stand for?	Massive hemorrhage, Airway, Respiration, Circulation, Hypothermia/Head injury.
Q What is line 1 of a 9-line?	Location of the pickup site.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q Where do you place a tourniquet in Care Under Fire?	High and tight on the injured limb. VERIFY ATP 4-02.11.
Q What is the most preventable cause of death on the battlefield?	Bleeding from an extremity (massive hemorrhage).
Q What's in your IFAK?	Know your issued contents: tourniquet, pressure dressing, hemostatic gauze, nasopharyngeal airway, chest seal, etc. LOCAL
Q What does precedence A, Urgent, mean?	Evacuate within 1 hour.

20 Land Navigation

TC 3-25.26, Map Reading and Land Navigation (15 Nov 2013). Not FM 3-25.26.

MUST KNOW **5 Major**

Hill · Saddle · Valley · Ridge · Depression

Cue: "Hidden Valley Ranch Salad Dressing" (different order, same 5).

MUST KNOW **3 Minor**

Draw · Spur · Cliff

MUST KNOW **2 Supplementary**

Cut · Fill

Map colors VERIFY

Color	Shows
Black	Cultural (man-made) features other than roads
Red-Brown	On newer maps: combined cultural, relief, and elevation features (contour lines readable under red light)
Blue	Water: lakes, rivers, swamps
Green	Vegetation with military significance: woods, orchards
Brown	Relief features and elevation (contours on older maps)
Red	Cultural features: populated areas, main roads, boundaries (older maps)
Other	Special information, explained in the marginal information

KNOW **Three norths:** True, Magnetic, Grid. The **declination diagram** shows the angles between them.

KNOW **Grid precision:** 6-digit = 100 m. **8-digit = 10 m.** Read **right, then up**.

KNOW **Contour lines:** Index (heavier, numbered), Intermediate, Supplementary (dashed).

KNOW **Lensatic compass:** 360 degrees or 6400 mils. Holding techniques: **center-hold** and **compass-to-cheek**.

KNOW **Intersection** finds an unknown point using two known points. **Resection** finds your own location using two or more known points.

BONUS Standard military map scale: **1:50,000**. Know your own **pace count** per 100 m.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q Name the five major terrain features.	Hill, saddle, valley, ridge, depression.
Q Minor and supplementary?	Minor: draw, spur, cliff. Supplementary: cut, fill.
Q An 8-digit grid is accurate to how many meters?	10 meters.
Q What are the three norths?	True, magnetic, and grid north.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q What is the scale of a standard military map?	1:50,000.
Q What do you use to determine your location?	Resection, using two or more known points.
Q How many mils in a circle?	6,400.

21 Drill, Ceremony & Customs

TC 3-21.5 (3 May 2021) and AR 600-25 (1 May 2026).

Drill VERIFY

KNOW Most commands have two parts: **preparatory command** ("Forward") and **command of execution** ("MARCH").

KNOW **Types of commands:** two-part, combined, supplementary, directives.

KNOW **Rest positions at the halt:** Parade Rest, Stand at Ease, At Ease, Rest.

Step	Length	Cadence
Quick time	30 in	120 steps/min
Double time	30 in	180 steps/min
Half step	15 in	120 steps/min
Side / back step	15 in	120 steps/min

Customs & courtesies VERIFY

KNOW **Salute** commissioned and warrant officers, the Medal of Honor recipient, the flag during the anthem or colors, and during reveille and retreat.

KNOW **Generally no salute:** indoors (except when formally reporting), in the field or under tactical conditions, when both hands are full, or when the act would be impractical. Follow AR 600-25.

KNOW **Reveille and retreat:** face the flag (or the sound of music), stand at attention, and salute on the first note. In a vehicle, stop and sit at attention.

KNOW When an NCO addresses you: stand at **parade rest** for a senior NCO and answer "Sergeant" or "First Sergeant."

WITHHELD

Your old notes listed holiday gun-salute numbers and indoor-salute exceptions with no source. Don't memorize those. If asked, cite AR 600-25.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **What manual covers drill and ceremonies?**	TC 3-21.5.
Q **What regulation covers salutes and honors?**	AR 600-25, Salutes, Honors, and Courtesy.
Q **What are the two parts of most drill commands?**	The preparatory command and the command of execution.
Q **How long is a quick-time step, and at what cadence?**	30 inches at 120 steps per minute.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q **Name the four rest positions.**	Parade rest, stand at ease, at ease, rest.
Q **When do you not salute?**	Indoors (except when formally reporting), in the field or under tactical conditions, or when both hands are full. VERIFY AR 600-25.
Q **What is the double-time cadence?**	180 steps per minute, 30 inches.

22 4ID, 2SBCT & 2-12 IN

The CSM and all four 1SGs are 2-12. Unit pride questions are almost guaranteed.

MEDAL OF HONOR: COMPANY C, 2-12 INFANTRY

On **18 June 2026**, President Trump presented the **Medal of Honor** to **MAJ (Ret.) Nicholas Dockery** at the White House. He was a **Platoon Leader in Company C, 2nd Battalion, 12th Infantry Regiment**, in **Kapisa Province, Afghanistan**. The award upgraded his Silver Star. He led a counterattack to clear a courtyard and shielded a Soldier from an enemy grenade blast. **That's your company. Expect this question.** VERIFY the date of action and the exact citation wording at army.mil/medalofhonor/dockery.

2nd Battalion, 12th Infantry: "Lethal Warriors"

MUST KNOW **Constituted 3 May 1861** in the Regular Army as **Company B, 1st Battalion, 12th Infantry**. **Organized 20 October 1861 at Fort Hamilton, New York.** FIXED Your old notes had 1-12's lineage (Company A). VERIFY the official CMH lineage certificate.

KNOW Nickname: **"Lethal Warriors."** Reorganized as a **Stryker battalion** under **2SBCT, 4ID** in 2021, alongside 1-12 IN.

KNOW Recent missions: Joint Task Force-Southern Border (2025). NTC rotation at Fort Irwin, CA, including a Javelin FTX (Jul 2026).

BONUS 12th Infantry coat of arms: the **sea lion** comes from the arms of the Philippine Islands. The crest commemorates the capture of a Spanish flag at **El Caney** (1898). Motto: LOCAL confirm it with the battalion. Sources disagree.

4th Infantry Division: "Ivy Division"

MUST KNOW Motto: **"Steadfast and Loyal."** Nicknames: **"Ivy"** (from the Roman numeral IV) and **"Iron Horse."** VERIFY

KNOW Organized in **December 1917 at Camp Greene, North Carolina** for World War I. VERIFY

MUST KNOW WWII: landed first at **Utah Beach, 6 June 1944**. **BG Theodore Roosevelt Jr.** received the Medal of Honor for his leadership there. The CG spoke at the Utah Beach ceremony on 6 June 2026.

KNOW Iraq: 4ID units captured **Saddam Hussein** on 13 Dec 2003 (Operation Red Dawn).

KNOW Transformation: 4ID is converting to the Army's **only all-Stryker infantry division**. The 3rd Armored Brigade ("Iron Brigade") is converting to Strykers.

KNOW Brigade: **2nd Stryker Brigade Combat Team, "Warhorse."**

4ID standards

KNOW IVY READY

R Respect | **E** Experts | **A** Athlete | **D** Discipline | **Y** You

From the 4ID standards book. It's a division source, not Army-wide.

KNOW IVY FOUR

1. Physical Fitness
2. Marksmanship
3. Small Unit Drills
4. Medical Proficiency

LOCAL CHECK LIST

IVY 7 (not in your source; get it from the unit) · battalion and brigade campaign streamers and honors · CSM and commander philosophy · battalion crest meaning · company nickname/motto · current policy letters (4ID policy letters page).

BOARD ANSWERS

Q **How was 2-12 Infantry constituted?**	On 3 May 1861 in the Regular Army as Company B, 1st Battalion, 12th Infantry. Organized 20 Oct 1861 at Fort Hamilton, New York.

Q Who is the most recent Medal of Honor recipient from your company?	MAJ (Ret.) Nicholas Dockery, a C Co, 2-12 IN platoon leader in Kapisa Province, Afghanistan. Presented 18 June 2026.

FOLLOW-UPS THE 1SGS ASK NEW

Q What is the 2-12 IN nickname?	Lethal Warriors.
Q What brigade are you in, and what is its nickname?	2nd Stryker Brigade Combat Team, "Warhorse."
Q Why the ivy leaf on the 4ID patch?	"Ivy" sounds like the Roman numeral IV. Ivy leaves stand for tenacity and fidelity. VERIFY
Q What makes 4ID unique right now?	It's converting to the Army's only all-Stryker infantry division.

23 Major Wars & Unit Combat History

The Army's major wars, and where 4ID and the 12th Infantry fought in each.

America's major wars

War	Years (U.S.)	Key facts for the board
Revolutionary War	1775–1783	The Army (Continental Army) was born on **14 June 1775**. Von Steuben's Blue Book defined NCO duties.
War of 1812	1812–1815	Against Britain. The defense of Fort McHenry inspired "The Star-Spangled Banner."
Mexican-American War	1846–1848	Many Civil War leaders first saw combat here.
Civil War	1861–1865	The bloodiest U.S. war. The **Medal of Honor** was created (Army version 1862). The **12th Infantry was constituted in 1861.**
Spanish-American War	1898	Cuba and the Philippines. 12th Infantry at **El Caney**.
Philippine-American War	1899–1902	12th Infantry served in the Philippines. The sea lion on the regimental crest comes from this.
World War I	1917–1918	4ID organized in Dec 1917. Fought in the Aisne-Marne, St. Mihiel and Meuse-Argonne campaigns.
World War II	1941–1945	**4ID landed first at Utah Beach, 6 June 1944 (D-Day).** Fought at Cherbourg, the Hürtgen Forest and the Battle of the Bulge.
Korean War	1950–1953	Ended in an armistice, not a peace treaty. U.S. forces are still in South Korea.
Vietnam War	About 1965–1973 (major U.S. combat)	4ID deployed 1966–1970 to the Central Highlands. 2-12 IN served in Vietnam (with the 25th ID). VERIFY
Grenada (Urgent Fury)	1983	
Panama (Just Cause)	1989	
Gulf War (Desert Shield/Storm)	1990–1991	The 100-hour ground war liberated Kuwait.
Somalia (Restore Hope)	1992–1993	Battle of Mogadishu, Oct 1993.
Global War on Terrorism	2001–present	**OEF** (Operation Enduring Freedom), Afghanistan 2001–2014. **OIF** (Operation Iraqi Freedom), Iraq 2003–2010. **OND** (Operation New Dawn) 2010–2011. **OIR** (Operation Inherent Resolve) against ISIS, 2014–. **OFS** (Operation Freedom's Sentinel), Afghanistan 2015–2021.

4th Infantry Division in combat VERIFY

KNOW — **WWI:** Aisne-Marne, St. Mihiel, Meuse-Argonne.

MUST KNOW — **WWII:** The **8th, 12th and 22nd Infantry Regiments** made up 4ID. They landed first on **Utah Beach**. **BG Theodore Roosevelt Jr.** landed with the first wave and received the Medal of Honor. Then Cherbourg, the liberation of Paris, the **Hürtgen Forest** and the **Battle of the Bulge** in Luxembourg.

KNOW — **Vietnam:** 1966–1970. Central Highlands.

MUST KNOW — **OIF:** 4ID Soldiers captured **Saddam Hussein** near Tikrit on **13 December 2003** (Operation Red Dawn).

12th Infantry Regiment VERIFY

KNOW — **Civil War:** fought with the Regular Army ("the Regulars") in the eastern campaigns, including **Gettysburg**.

KNOW — **Spanish-American War:** El Caney, Cuba, 1898. The crest commemorates capturing a Spanish flag there.

MUST KNOW — **WWII:** one of 4ID's three infantry regiments. Landed at Utah Beach, fought in the Hürtgen Forest, and held the line in Luxembourg during the Battle of the Bulge.

KNOW **OEF:** multiple deployments to Afghanistan. The Dockery Medal of Honor action (C Co, 2-12 IN) was in Kapisa Province.

KNOW **GWOT:** 2-12 IN deployed to Iraq and Afghanistan. Became a Stryker battalion in 2SBCT, 4ID in 2021.

KNOW **Recent:** Joint Task Force-Southern Border (2025). NTC rotation (2026).

LOCAL Ask for the battalion's official campaign streamers and unit decorations. They're usually posted at battalion HQ.

BOARD ANSWERS

Q Where did 4ID land on D-Day?	Utah Beach, 6 June 1944. It was the first division ashore there.
Q Who received the Medal of Honor for Utah Beach?	BG Theodore Roosevelt Jr.
Q Which 4ID unit captured Saddam Hussein, and when?	4ID Soldiers, near Tikrit, 13 December 2003, during Operation Red Dawn.
Q What were 4ID's three infantry regiments in WWII?	The 8th, 12th and 22nd Infantry Regiments.
Q What does OEF stand for? OIF?	Operation Enduring Freedom (Afghanistan). Operation Iraqi Freedom (Iraq).
Q When did the Revolutionary War start?	1775. The Army's birthday is 14 June 1775.

24 Situational Questions

"Specialist, you're a team leader and..." There's no single right answer. The board wants to see you think like an NCO.

THE 5-PART ANSWER

1. Safety first: is anyone in danger? · **2. Take immediate action:** stop it, correct it, or secure it. · **3. Find the facts:** talk to the Soldier. · **4. Use the right resource or regulation**, and **inform your chain**. · **5. Document and follow up** (DA Form 4856).
Speak in the first person and in the order you'd act: "First Sergeant, first I would..., then I would..."

Discipline & standards

Situation	A strong answer
Your Soldier is late to formation for the second time.	Talk to them privately to find out why. Do event counseling on a DA Form 4856 with a plan of action. Apply corrective training if appropriate. Inform your squad leader. Follow up. If it keeps happening, it moves up the chain.
A Soldier from another unit walks past you out of uniform standard.	Make an on-the-spot correction, professionally and respectfully. Every NCO enforces standards, not just the ones in their own unit.
Your Soldier failed the AFT.	Find out why: injury, preparation, or effort. Build a plan with them (H2F resources, extra PT). Counsel and document. Follow your chain's policy on flags and retests.
Your Soldier failed the ABCP waist-to-height check.	Make sure the assessment followed AD 2026-13 (a second team confirmed it, recorded on DA Form 5500). Counsel the Soldier. Connect them with H2F dietitians and trainers. Inform your chain. Be supportive and hold the standard.
You smell alcohol on your Soldier at first formation.	Remove them from duty and from any weapon or vehicle. Inform your squad leader or PSG right away. The command decides on testing. ASAP referral (AR 600-85). Document it.
Your Soldier posted a photo of the vehicle line and the deployment date on social media.	Have them take it down right away. Explain the OPSEC risk (AR 530-1). Inform your chain, since it may need to be reported. Counsel and retrain.

Soldier care

Situation	A strong answer
Your Soldier says, "Sometimes I don't see the point of anything anymore."	**ACE.** Ask directly: "Are you thinking about killing yourself?" Care: listen and take it seriously. Escort: stay with them and take them to Behavioral Health, the chaplain or the ER. Never leave them alone. Inform your chain. If there's immediate danger, call 911.
A Soldier tells you they were sexually assaulted.	Make sure they're safe and get medical care if needed. **Don't promise confidentiality.** Tell them you have to report it, and connect them with the SARC or SHARP VA right away. The VA explains restricted and unrestricted reporting. Don't investigate yourself. Protect their privacy. AR 600-52.
Your Soldier is being harassed by another Soldier because of their race.	Stop the behavior. Make sure the victim is safe. Inform your chain. Explain the EO complaint options: informal, or formal on DA Form 7279. Connect them with the unit EOL. Protect them from retaliation. AR 600-20 Ch 6.
Your Soldier can't pay rent this month.	Find out the cause. AER for emergency assistance. ACS financial readiness counseling. Help them build a budget. Follow up next payday.
Your Soldier's family member is in the hospital back home.	Inform your chain right away for emergency leave. Red Cross message. AER for travel funds if needed. Check on them while they're gone.

A new Soldier just arrived on your team.	Sponsor them. Do the initial counseling within the first 30 days. Learn their background, goals and family situation. Get them through in-processing, issue and training. Pair them with a battle buddy.

Leadership & mission

Situation	A strong answer
You get an order you think is unsafe.	Bring your concern to the leader who gave it, respectfully, with facts and risk-management steps. If it's lawful, execute it with controls in place. If it's clearly illegal, do not obey, and report it through the chain.
Your squad leader is gone and the PSG gives your team a mission.	Acknowledge it and back-brief. Use the TLPs: issue a WARNORD, plan, inspect (PCCs/PCIs), execute. Report completion. "Initiative by taking appropriate action in the absence of orders." (NCO Creed)
Two of your Soldiers keep arguing and it's affecting the team.	Separate them and talk to each one individually. Find the root cause. Mediate. Set clear expectations. Counsel if needed. Inform your squad leader if it keeps happening.
Your team is behind on PMCS before a field problem.	Prioritize: get the vehicle and weapons mission-capable first. Divide the tasks by who knows what. Inform the chain about deadline faults early, not at the last minute. Do an AAR afterward so it doesn't happen again.
Your friend from your old team is now your Soldier.	Have the conversation early. Explain the relationship has changed professionally. Enforce the same standard for everyone. Avoid any appearance of favoritism (AR 600-20 / AR 600-32).
You made a mistake that affected the mission.	Own it right away. Tell your leader what happened and what you're doing to fix it. Learn from it in the AAR. Integrity matters more than looking good.

Tactical

Situation	A strong answer
Your team makes contact on a patrol.	Return fire and take cover. Locate the enemy. Send a SALUTE report. Gain fire superiority. Follow the battle drill (react to contact) and the squad leader's direction. Send a LACE report after contact.
A Soldier on your team is wounded under fire.	Care Under Fire: win the fight first. Direct the casualty to self-aid and cover. Once it's safe, apply a tourniquet if there's massive bleeding. Move to Tactical Field Care (MARCH). Request MEDEVAC with a 9-line.
You find a suspected IED on your route.	Stop. Don't touch it. Confirm from a distance. Clear the area. Cordon it off. Check for secondary devices. Control the area. Report with a 9-line UXO/IED report. VERIFY the 5 Cs: Confirm, Clear, Call, Cordon, Control.

25 8-Day Plan & Board-Day Checklist

Every day: the creed once out loud, one mock-board session, and the Situational Questions section.

Day	Focus	Also do
Thu 12 Nov	Sec 0 corrections · Sec 1 Creeds · Sec 5 Army basics	Ask the 1SG/PSG for the MOI date and chain-of-command names
Fri 13 Nov	Sec 3 Chain of command · Sec 22 2-12 / 4ID · Sec 23 Wars & history	Fill in every blank in Sec 3
Sat 14 Nov	Sec 4 Personal · Sec 6 Leadership & counseling · Sec 12 Benefits	Write your "about yourself" answer and say it out loud 5 times
Sun 15 Nov	Sec 7 Regs & UCMJ · Sec 8 SHARP/EO/Suicide	Get the AGSU fitted and pressed
Mon 16 Nov	Sec 14 Tactics · Sec 15 Acronyms · Sec 13 Training & CBRN	Have an NCO inspect your AGSU with a ruler
Tue 17 Nov	Sec 16 Your weapons · Sec 17 Weapon systems · Sec 18 Comms & maintenance	Check your ERB/ORB matches your rack
Wed 18 Nov	Sec 10 ABCP · Sec 11 H2F · Sec 19 TCCC · Sec 9 Wear · Sec 20 Land nav · Sec 21 Drill	Full mock board in AGSU, with knocking and reporting
Thu 19 Nov	Review all "Must know" tags · Sec 24 Situational questions	Haircut. Light review only. Sleep 8 hours.
Fri 20 Nov	**BOARD**	Creed once in the morning. Eat. Arrive early.

Before you leave the house

- ☐ AGSU on, inspected, lint-rolled
- ☐ Shoes shined. Spare shirt in the car.
- ☐ Fresh haircut. Shaved that morning.
- ☐ CAC / ID
- ☐ Lint roller, small sewing kit
- ☐ Water. Something light to eat.

Outside the board room

- ☐ Arrive 30+ minutes early
- ☐ Final mirror check: brass, ribbons, gig line
- ☐ Say the creed once in your head
- ☐ Deep breaths. Slow down.
- ☐ Phone off and out of your pockets
- ☐ Knock once, firmly

OPEN ITEMS BEFORE 20 NOVEMBER

- ☐ Get the MOI: uniform details, reporting procedure, creed, topics
- ☐ Confirm every name in Section 3
- ☐ IVY 7, the CSM's and commander's philosophy, unit honors, company nickname
- ☐ Your M4 zero, your ACOG model, your issued IFAK contents
- ☐ Your unit SARC/VA, EOL, and chaplain names
- ☐ Compare the creed text word for word against army.mil

26 Publication Types, Index & Sources

Board-relevant publications only. Dates are the APD indexed dates from your original guide.

Publication types NEW

Type	Full name & purpose
ADP	Army Doctrine Publication: fundamental principles (the what and why)
FM	Field Manual: tactics, more detail than an ADP
ATP	Army Techniques Publication: techniques (the how)
TC	Training Circular: training guidance for tasks, weapons, drills
TM	Technical Manual: operating and maintaining equipment (-10 = operator)
STP / GTA	Soldier Training Publication / Graphic Training Aid
JP	Joint Publication: doctrine for all services

Type	Full name & purpose
AR	Army Regulation: mandatory policy
DA Pam	Department of the Army Pamphlet: procedures for carrying out an AR
AD	Army Directive: new Secretary of the Army policy, effective right away
DA Form	Department of the Army Form
ALARACT	All Army Activities message
APD	Army Publishing Directorate (armypubs.army.mil)
C1, C2	Change 1, Change 2 to a publication

DOCTRINE ORDER

ADP (principles) → **FM** (tactics) → **ATP** (techniques). Each level adds detail. **ADRP** and **ATTP** are retired types, so don't cite them.

Pub	Title	Date
ADP 1	The Army	31 Jul 2019
ADP 6-22	Army Leadership and the Profession (C2)	31 Jul 2019
ADP 7-0	Training	29 Apr 2024
ATP 3-21.8	Infantry Rifle Platoon and Squad (C1)	11 Jan 2024
ATP 3-21.9	Stryker Infantry Rifle Platoon and Squad	24 Jun 2025
ATP 4-02.11	Casualty Response, TCCC, and First Aid	23 Mar 2026
ATP 6-22.1	Counseling–Coaching–Mentoring	13 Feb 2024
ATP 7-22.01	Holistic Health and Fitness Testing	12 Mar 2026
ATP 7-22.02	H2F Drills and Exercises (C1)	1 Oct 2020
FM 7-22	Holistic Health and Fitness (C2)	1 Oct 2020
FM 6-22	Developing Leaders (C2)	1 Nov 2022
TC 3-21.5	Drill and Ceremonies	3 May 2021

Pub / Form	Title	Date
AR 600-20	Army Command Policy	15 Apr 2026
AR 600-52	SHARP Program	11 Feb 2025
AR 600-92	Army Suicide Prevention Program	4 Oct 2024
AR 600-8-19	Enlisted Promotions and Demotions	6 Mar 2026
AR 600-8-22	Military Awards	11 May 2026
AR 600-9	Army Body Composition Program	16 Jul 2019
AR 623-3	Evaluation Reporting System	14 Feb 2025
AR 670-1 / DA Pam 670-1	Wear and Appearance	26 Jan 2021
AR 350-1	Army Training and Leader Development	1 Jun 2025
AR 600-85	Army Substance Abuse Program	4 Oct 2024
AR 600-25	Salutes, Honors, and Courtesy	1 May 2026
AR 930-4	Army Emergency Relief	15 Apr 2026

TC 3-22.9	Rifle and Carbine (C1–C3)	13 May 2016
TC 3-22.249	Light Machine Gun M249	16 May 2017
TC 3-22.240	Medium Machine Gun	28 Apr 2017
TC 3-25.26	Map Reading and Land Navigation	15 Nov 2013
TC 7-21.13	The Soldier's Guide	17 Sep 2025
TC 7-22.7	The NCO Guide	19 Aug 2025
DA Pam 750-1	Army Materiel Maintenance Procedures	29 Apr 2026

AR 27-10	Military Justice	8 Jan 2025
DA Form 4856	Developmental Counseling Form	1 Mar 2023
DA Form 2166-9-1	NCOER (SGT)	1 Nov 2015
DA Form 5500	Body Composition Worksheet	1 Jul 2026
DA Form 7279 / 7746	EO & Harassment / SH Complaint	Jul 2020 / Jan 2026
AD 2025-13, 2025-18, 2026-09	Grooming / appearance / religious accommodation	2025–2026
AD 2026-07 / 2026-13	Physical fitness standards / ABCP	17 Apr / 1 Jul 2026

Sources

Original guide sources: armypubs.army.mil · army.mil/values · army.mil/tellyourformation · army.mil/aft · CFT directive api.army.mil/e2/c/downloads/2026/04/29/858da01e/cft-army-directive.pdf · ATP 3-21.8 (home.army.mil/benning) · TC 3-22.9 / 3-22.249 / 3-22.240 (rdl.train.army.mil) · ATP 7-22.02 (benning.army.mil) · AR 600-52 (sharplearningportal.army.mil) · 4ID Green Book, Yellow Book, standards book (home.army.mil/carson) · TRADOC Pam 672-9.
Added in this revision: 2-12 IN, 2SBCT 4ID (army.mil/article/289569; dvidshub.net) · Dockery Medal of Honor (army.mil/article/293359; army.mil/medalofhonor/dockery; 4thinfantry.org) · 2-12 lineage (globalsecurity.org/military/agency/army/2-12in.htm; verify at history.army.mil) · 4ID leadership (army.mil/article/286497; home.army.mil/carson 4ID leadership page) · HQDA principal officials roster (api.army.mil, Aug 2026) · CSA change (defensescoop.com, 2 Apr 2026) · SGT eligibility (HQDA cutoff-score memo, Feb 2026) · AFT combat standard (army.mil/aft) · AGSU ribbons/badges (army.mil/uniforms FAQ; DA Pam 670-1) · ICVV (Stryker variants references) · 2SBCT commander page (home.army.mil/carson/.../2sbct/brigade-commander).
Standard doctrine added from general knowledge, tagged VERIFY: creed texts, counseling process, UCMJ articles, weapon data, 9-line, map colors, drill step lengths, NCO history.